

KIT 3 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · RUN KITS 1 AND 2 FIRST

AI for Planning & Differentiation

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready.

What this session is

Kit 2 taught the four-part prompt formula; this session puts it to work on the job that eats the most planning time. Staff learn a four-step planning workflow (draft, options, pick, review), four differentiation moves with copy-ready prompts (level it, scaffold it, stretch it, reformat it), a quick habit for verifying reading levels, and a 4-point review checklist for any AI-drafted material. The lab is the point: **every teacher brings one upcoming lesson and leaves with a fully differentiated artifact for it:** core version, support version, extension, reviewed and teachable that week.

The quiet payoff: the research on differentiation (the Deunk meta-analysis) says it helps most when it's embedded in instruction and supported by technology, and the honest reason most of us couldn't sustain it was never commitment; it was hours. Drafting just got cheap. Judgment stayed expensive, and judgment is the part your staff already has.

Who should present it

Same bar as Kits 1 and 2: any confident colleague. You do not need to be a differentiation expert; the four moves are fully scripted with worked prompts, the answers to likely questions are in boxes, and a wrong reading-level label caught live during the lab is a teaching gift, not a failure.

One prep item matters most: the lesson. The lab only works if staff walk in with a real upcoming lesson (plan book, unit page, even a topic and a date). Say it in the invite, say it again the day before. Have two generic fallback lessons ready (one elementary, one secondary) for anyone who forgets; borrowing a partner's lesson also works fine.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
Welcome & the dilemma	0:00–0:05	Differentiation works but was never sustainable by hand; the 61% adoption stat; the promise
The planning workflow	0:05–0:12	Never from scratch again; the PLOS ONE 30-minute lesson study; the UDL options frame
The toolkit: four moves	0:12–0:24	Level it (+ check-the-level habit) · scaffold it · stretch it · reformat it, each with a worked prompt

Quality control	0:24– 0:30	The 4-point review; honest limits; the RAND equity note
Lab: your real lesson	0:30– 0:50	Draft the core artifact, differentiate two directions, run the 4-point review
Making it stick	0:50– 0:53	One artifact a week; commitment #5; Kit 4 preview
First 48 hours & close	0:53– 0:56	Action sheet + exit ticket

Core session is 56 minutes. For a 45-minute slot, staff differentiate one direction instead of two in the lab and the share-out takes two voices; the script marks the cuts.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Send the one-line staff email** (2 min): "Bring a charged device and one lesson you'll teach in the next two weeks. You'll leave with it differentiated." Resend the morning of.
- ☐ **Skim the script once** (5 min): the four toolkit prompts on slides 11–15 are the heart; read them aloud once so they land smoothly.
- ☐ **Click through the deck** (2 min): confirm all 30 slides display.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (3 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.
- ☐ **Open the staff prompt doc** (2 min): confirm the Kit 2 doc is alive and have the link ready to project; today's differentiation prompts get added to it. Prepare the two fallback lessons while you're there.

Room, tech & timing

Same setup as Kits 1 and 2: projector, Wi-Fi, pair seating, a visible clock. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30. It is the session. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab. If Wi-Fi fails, run the lab on the projector with one volunteered lesson and the room dictating the prompts; the 4-point review works well as a whole-group sport.

Facilitator FAQ

"What if someone says AI-leveled texts can't be trusted?"

Agree with the instinct; it's the session's own point. The PLOS ONE lesson-planning study found real problems in AI drafts, including a fabricated resource, which is exactly why the kit teaches check-the-level and the 4-point review rather than blind trust. The claim is never "trust the output"; it's "drafting is cheap, verification is yours."

"What if someone says differentiation itself is unsupported?"

Point to the Deunk meta-analysis in the References: small-to-moderate positive effects, strongest when differentiation is embedded in a broader program and supported by technology. It's a fair reading that grouping alone does little; that's in the same analysis, and it's why this session is about materials, not grouping.

"What about students with IEPs?"

Two answers. Practically: the scaffold and leveling moves draft accommodation-friendly materials fast, and the case manager or teacher reviews against the actual plan. Legally and ethically: never put a student's name, disability category, or any identifying detail into a public AI tool. Describe the need generically ("a student who needs sentence starters and extended time") and keep the IEP itself far away from the chat.

"What if someone asks whether this replaces planning periods or personnel?"

No, and don't let the framing stand. The tool compresses the drafting step of planning; choosing, adapting, and reviewing still take professional time, which is the argument for protecting planning periods, not shrinking them.

"What if staff want tool recommendations?"

Stay tool-agnostic: the moves work in every major chatbot. If your district has approved a specific tool, use that one in the lab and say so plainly.

After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as PD documentation.
- Skim the "differentiation task I still want help with" column; those become the PLC follow-up material in the 30-day plan.
- Check the staff prompt doc for new differentiation prompts; nudge stragglers with one friendly line.

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